

How to Sound Pretty

“

What is rhetoric?!?!

What Rhetoric Is

The art of sounding pretty ✨

The use of diction, syntax and rhetorical devices to make what you're saying engaging, persuasive and impactful

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Why do I even need
rhetoric??

Why Rhetoric is Important

- Helps you humanize your impacts & gives you opportunity for emotional variation
- Makes your speech more memorable
- Points of argumentation can be highlighted/easier to understand
 - **Thematics**

What you say is only as good as how you say it

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Great, so how can I use it?

Where You Can Put Rhetoric

- Intros and conclusions
 - Lowkey non negotiable like at least try
 - More on intros later
- After/within your “debate” impact
 - Put the human in humanization

Where You Can Put Rhetoric

- Transition points
 - Within transitional phrases
 - In refutation
- Anywhere you want emotion within your speech

Wherever you put it, rhetoric should enhance, not distract from, your argument

* RHETORIC

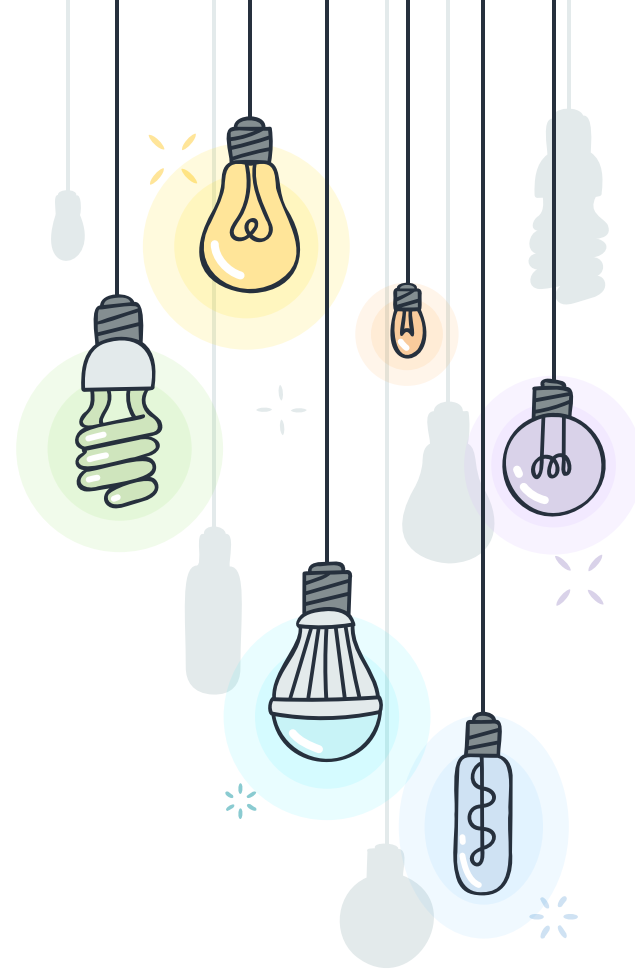
TWO TYPES:

Explanatory rhetoric-short phrases to simplify ideas like “dropping the ball” or “watered down private prisons” or anything like that

Humanizing rhetoric-poetic storytelling to invoke emotion something that belongs in an intro or conclusion

Where does it go?

- Intro
- Impact 1
- Impact 2
- Conclusion



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But I can't think of any!

* WHERE DO I FIND RHETORIC

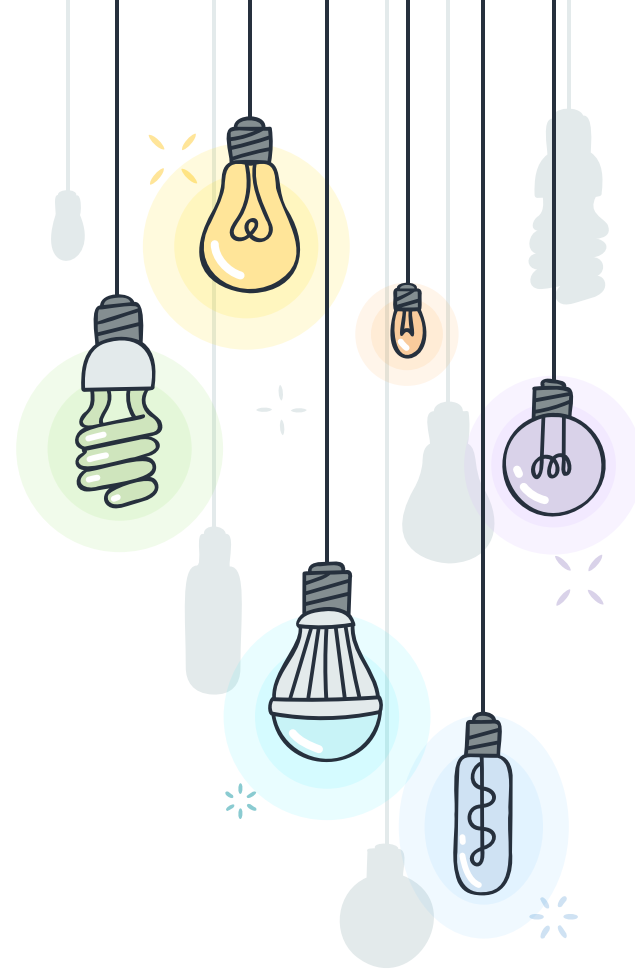
Original ideas:

- Rhetoric should always be on your mind when prepping
- Read into potential symbolism, metaphors, impacting
- Look for stories or anecdotes for a potential *thematic*

Searching for rhetoric:

- Not the onion
- News articles: often intros or titles
- Jokes: comedians that comment on current events like Trevor Noah....

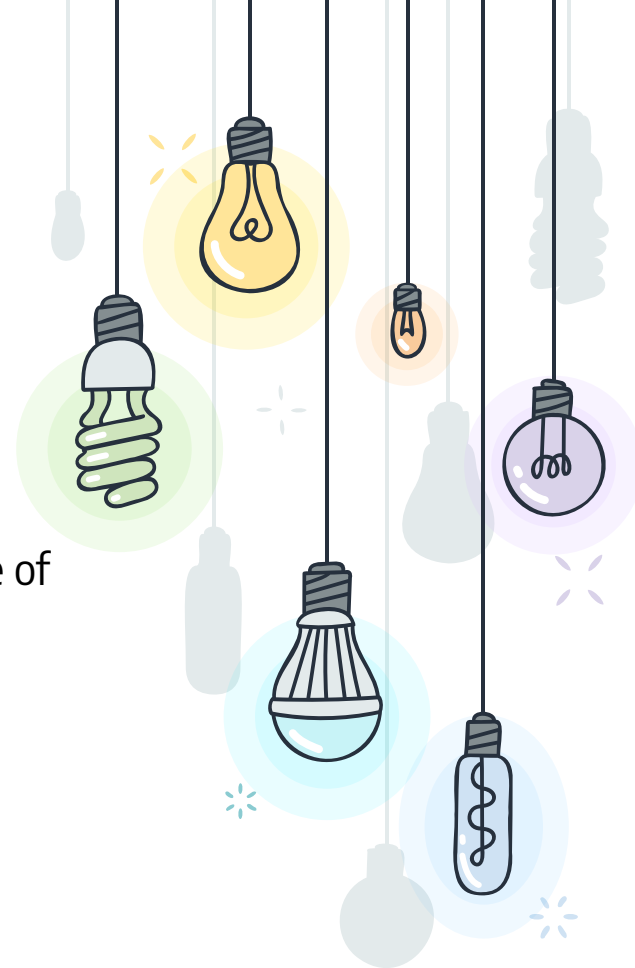
Questions?



✧ EX.

- this isn't a story of statistics it is a story of suffering
- not for free but for freedom (I love alliteration)
- It's a powder keg of violence, and our constituents are getting caught in the crossfire
- Instead of using these people as pawns in our political game of chess we must give sanctions up...

Who can add some more rhetoric now that i've set up the story of a chess game



*THEMATICS+JOKES

Useful until they get overuse - be mindful

- Book/play: Chapters, act 1, scene 1

Follow someone's life story ex. skin in the game

****A lot of times there is a respect factor

Following an anecdotal is good and important when it comes to sensitive topics (SA)

Jokes are more often a miss but when it works you are often then not top 6

- If the joke didn't work just say that to the audience then they'll have to laugh
- Don't be afraid to talk about lobbying and take jabs at people. Remember this is congress and role-playing. So play the part!
- Necessary with proper tone



Start with your intro

AGD - Link - Bar

Your AGD is a good starting point for a theme/topic you can carry throughout your speech.

How to AGD

- Needs to actually be interesting, attention grabbing, clever etc. **AND TOPICAL!!!!**
 - Anecdotal
 - Historical
 - Humorous
 - Irony/funny jokes
 - ACTUALLY interesting facts/statistics
 - Relate it to the round
- Look at Not the Onion, the beginning of articles for AGDs
- DONT be exploitative of ppl's struggles - speak about what you genuinely believe

Link

Tie to the theme of the bill/debate/your argument

Bar/Thesis

Concise and powerful. Clearly indicates your position.

Example:

Rarely does a font indicate an underlying problem in our society. However, when the shapes of grotesquely gerrymandered US districts form letters that make up the font Ugly Gerry, the problem has manifested itself in a new and scary way. It's time this congress rearrange the letters of our deformed gerrymandered alphabet and spell out a better future for America.

Samples Pt. 2

1. For years, mother America has been footing the bill for her grown up child, Israel. We disagree with their actions so we've scolded & reprimanded, yet we continue to empower their deplorable behavior with our checkbook. It's time to cut off our child. Affirm
2. Israel is like your best friend. They make some stupid decisions, but no matter what you stick by them. For the reason that cutting off aid is ending a vital relationship, we negate.

Rhetoric Generation Tips & Tricks

- Think about what sounds not clunky when you're delivering it
- Use language that's
 - Concise
 - Descriptive
 - Emotion filled

Conclusion

Grand finale of a Congress speech and should package everything the debater has explained into one cohesive, passionate statement. (15 to 30 seconds)

Tips & Tricks:

- It should focus on highlighting the impacts of your arguments
 - Tie everything together in one or few impactful sentences
- Like an Introduction, should be specific and end with debater encouraging to pass/fail
- Quotations work better because all relevant context has been explained thus audience can understand the quotations

Sample (*Good nd Bad*)

It is time that we once and for all abandon a failed policy. A failed policy that has allowed thousands of innocent Cubans to starve. A failed policy that has only entrenched the Cuban people further into dictatorship. A failed policy that has done absolutely nothing to destroy Castro's regime. We have to affirm this bill.

For the aforementioned reasons, we must affirm this bill.

Because Castro's regime is still in power, I urge a negative ballot on this legislation.

Rhetoric Generation Tips & Tricks

- Identify the themes of what your trying to enhance and tie to the “story” your telling
 - Story = either the overarching theme of your speech, a situation your trying to convey etc.
- Keep a rhetoric doc
 - Mostly for power lines or sound bites
- Experiment!!
 - ChatGPT !? 🙄